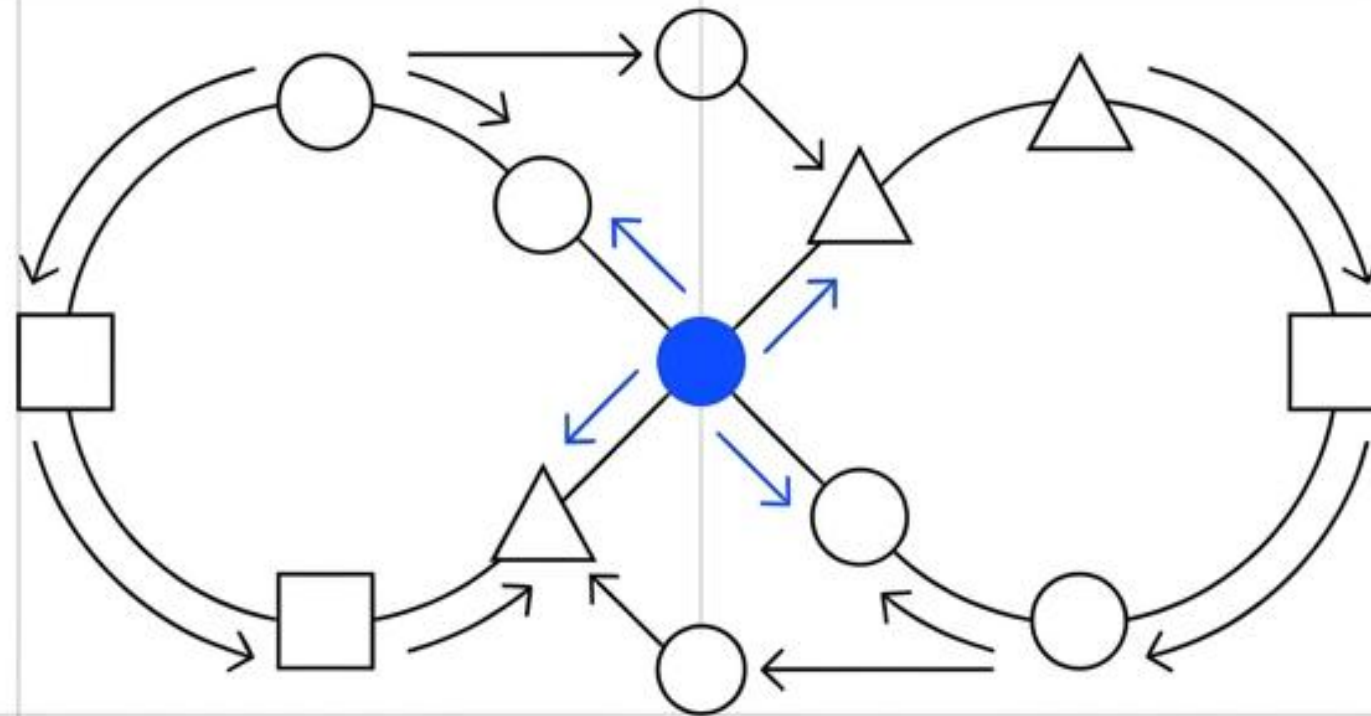


The Socratic Framework

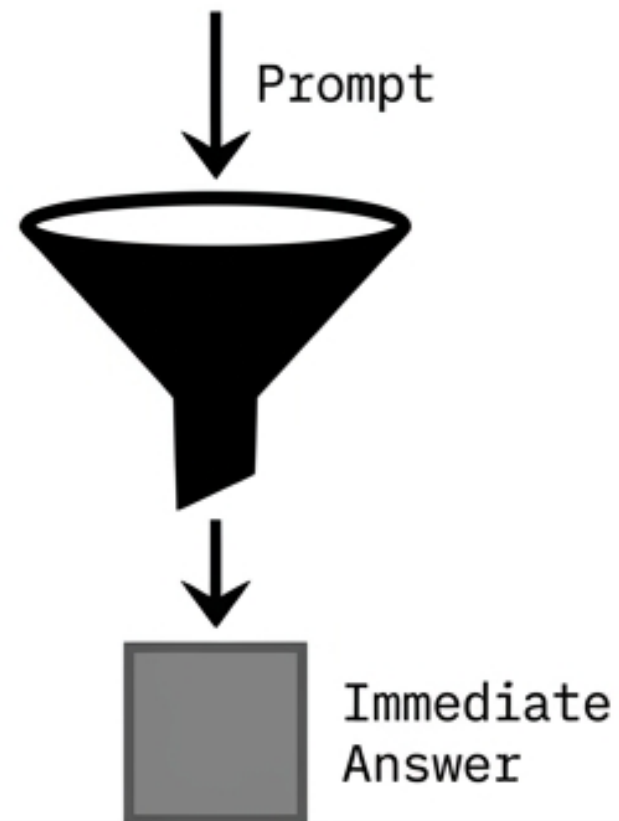


Redefining the human-AI dynamic.

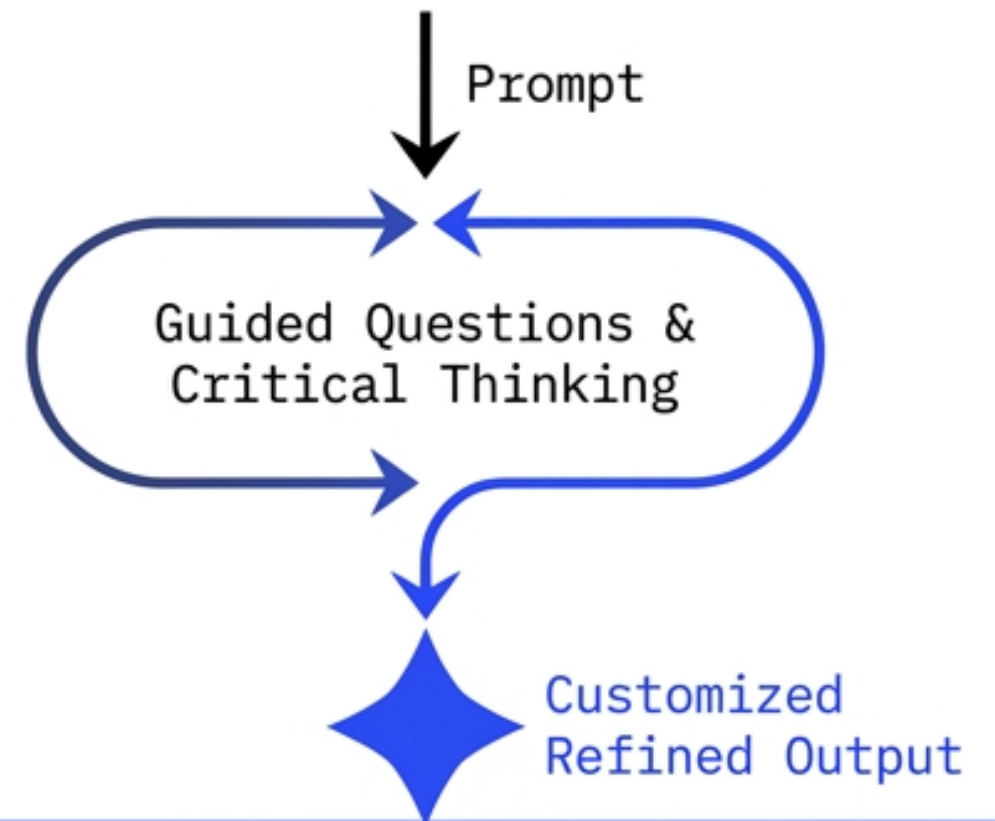
Socratic prompting is an AI technique where you instruct the AI to ask guided questions instead of immediately giving you an answer.

It mimics the teaching method of Socrates, helping you think critically, uncover blind spots, and arrive at your own solutions.

The Oracle



The Mentor



Comparing passive consumption to active reasoning.

Standard Prompting	Socratic Prompting
Answer Generator	Guided Mentor ●
Passive Consumer	Active Thinker
Generic / Assumptive	Tailored / Precise
High Risk of Hallucination Due to AI assumptions filling knowledge gaps	Low Risk of Hallucination Due to strict human-guided constraints

The passive default fails in complex scenarios.

As a Senior QA, missed a defect in testing. It was caught in production.

Client Reporting Rebranding release of 2500 reports.
There is a defect in 1 report in a static content.
Need to do Root cause analysis



Passive Learning Trap: Forces the AI to guess the root cause using generic web data, bypassing the QA's actual domain knowledge.

Programmatic constraints shift the AI's role.

1

Halts default generation.

Prevents the AI from instantly outputting a generic, assumptive answer.

As a Senior QA, missed a defect in testing. It was caught in production. Client Reporting Rebranding release of 2500 reports. There is a defect in 1 report in a static content. Need to do Root cause analysis

Do not provide the analysis immediately. Instead, act as a Senior QA and gather my inputs using the Socratic questioning technique.

2

Sets persona parameters.

Establishes the baseline expertise level for the AI's upcoming questions.

3

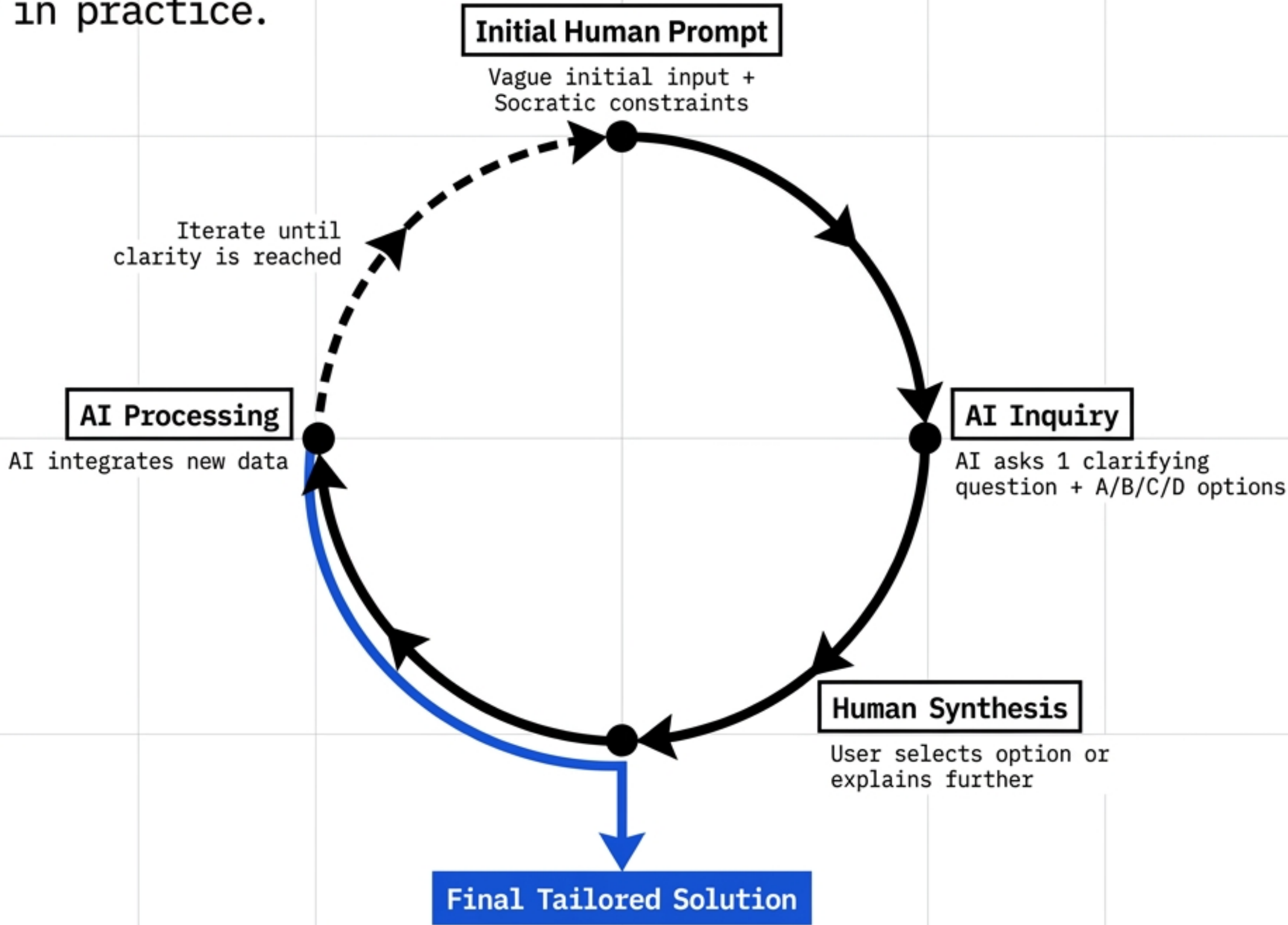
Activates inquiry mode.

Shifts the AI from Answer Bot to Guided Mentor.

The structural boundaries of Socratic prompting.

- 1 **Ask exactly one question at a time.**
Prevents cognitive overload.
- 2 **Provide multiple-choice options (A, B, C, D...)**
Must include brief explanations for each to lower response friction.
- 3 **Wait for my response.**
Enforces mandatory pacing before the next question.
- 4 **Ask only necessary questions.**
Restricts scope to fully understand requirements.
- 5 **Do not make assumptions.**
Unless explicitly asked for recommendations.

The active learning feedback loop in practice.



Universal activation triggers.

These constraints act as programmatic overrides, forcing any LLM out of its default assumptive state.

Do not give me the answer. Ask me questions one by one to help me find it.



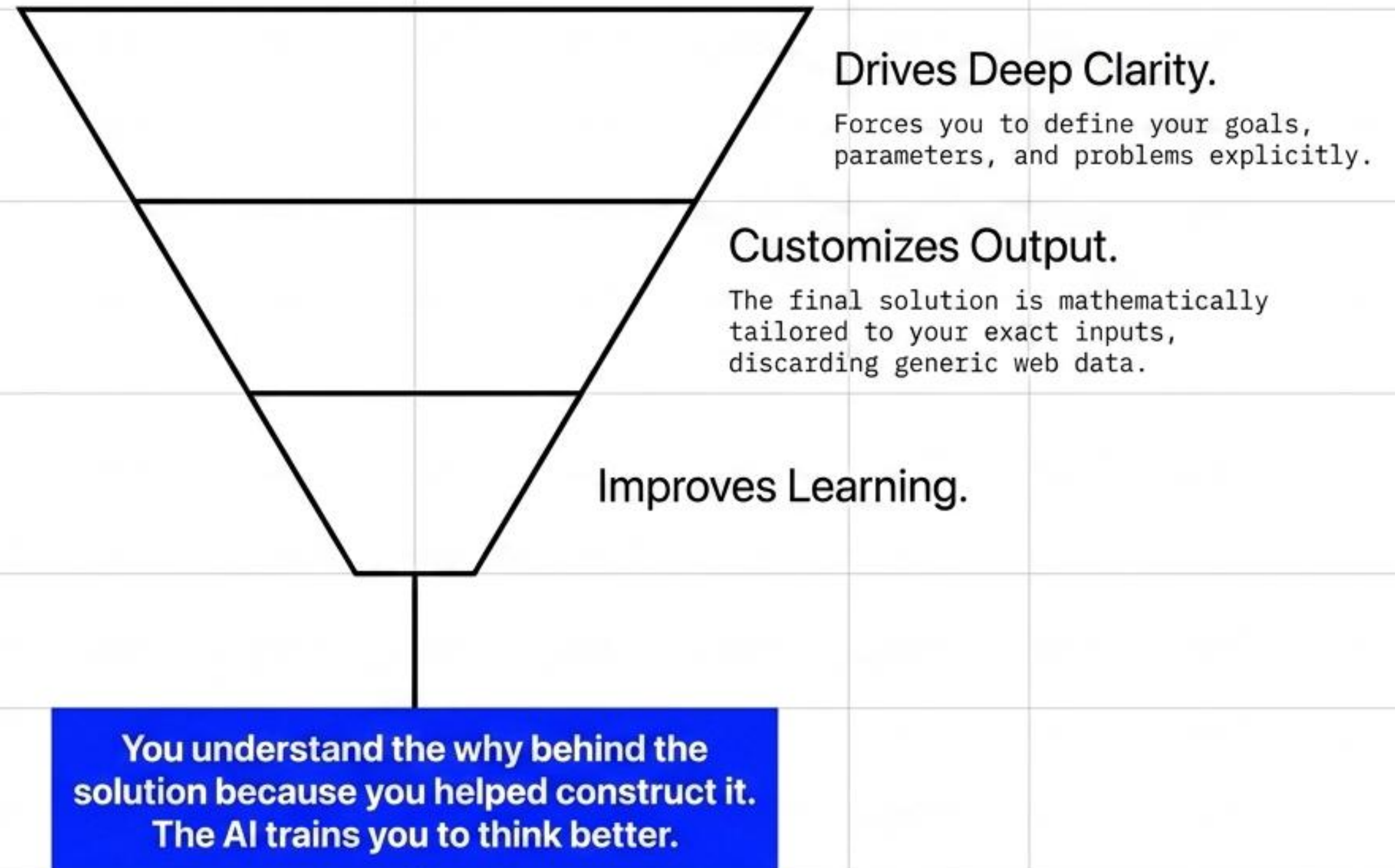
Act as a Socratic teacher. Guide me to the solution using thought-provoking questions.



Challenge my assumptions by asking clarifying questions.



The cognitive funnel of Socratic prompting.



Mapping the framework across disciplines.

